



CIVIL SERVICE DAY

21st April 2008

Government of India

Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions

Department of Administrative Reforms & Public Grievances

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नेभाग



ARMED FORCES

Only 3.5 per cent of armed forces officers of the rank of major general and above draw Rs 52,000 a month

Grade pay is available to just 15 per cent of the officers, i.e., brigadiers and above

It will take an army officer 33 years to reach an equivalent rank of major general. He can serve in the position for just five years before retirement.

POLICE

Less than a dozen police officials will enjoy parity with close to 200 secretary-rank IAS officials

Grade pays for all IPS officials is three-four years slower than in the administrative service

Promotion to the post of inspector general will take 20 years. The deputy inspector general's post is now functional, not supervisory.

to have different pay scales for IPS officers in the states and the Centre, then it should be done for IAS officers as well," a state DGP told INDIA TODAY.

Another big anomaly concerns the position of deputy inspector general (DIG) of police, which was earlier equivalent to that of a state commissioner from the IAS, but has now been made equivalent to an inspector

general's. Even as the police service has demanded that the DIG's post be put under a higher pay scale, it has been made a functional post instead of a supervisory one.

The army is unhappy with the imbalances in the military service pay, a monthly allowance that has been introduced by the pay commission. The IPS wants a similar police service pay,

OLIVE BRANCH: Manmohan Singh with IAS and IPS officers

arguing that its personnel face greater risks—such as threats from anti-social elements—as compared to the other civil services. Police officials have also been demanding risk-based pay, citing threat to life and injury. Indeed, the police force lost 4,972 officers in the last five years, with 994 casualties and over 8,000 personnel maimed/injured per year. Yet, some of the key proposals by the IPS, including a grant of hardship pay, have been turned down.

There are divisions among the Central police organisations (CPOs) too, with officials alleging that IPS officers are more concerned with their own cadre than the CPOs they head. The IPS Central Association, in a wish-list presented to Patil, has sought parity with the director-generals (DGs) of CPOs, who have been placed in a higher grade. But as per the commission's present recommendations, only DGs of the Border Security Force, the Central Reserve Police Force, the Central Industrial Security Force, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police and the Sashastra Seema Bal are in the higher pay band of Rs 80,000.

Another issue is that of grade pay for field postings at the district level. The police association has sought a higher grade pay for IPS officers in the districts so that they are not at a disadvantage as compared to IAS officers like the district magistrate or the additional district magistrate, who now come under a higher grade.

While the battle lines are drawn, it seems that the Government, which does not want any unpopularity creeping into the administrative and police machinery in a pre-election year, will extend an olive branch to calm the men in khaki. It has already set up a high-level official committee headed by Cabinet Secretary K.M. Chandrasekhar to look into the pay commission report. The prime minister, too, admitted that the Commission may have fallen short of expectations. "I would like our civil and defence services to be properly rewarded," he told a gathering of civil servants. A vast majority of his government machinery will be waiting to see if he puts his money where his mouth is. ■